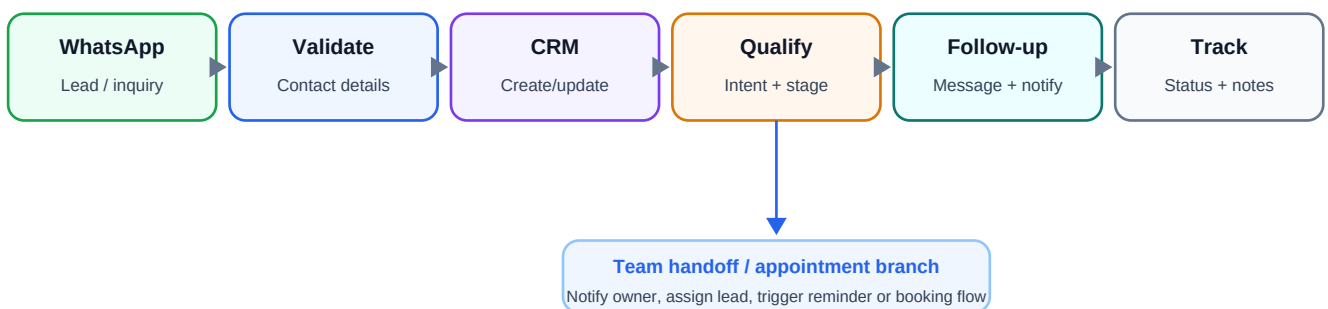


AI WhatsApp & CRM Automation

A practical lead-management workflow for capturing inquiries, updating CRM records, automating follow-up, moving opportunities through pipeline stages, and supporting appointment reminders.

Goal Reduce repetitive lead handling and improve response speed without losing CRM traceability.	Core stack WhatsApp - CRM / GoHighLevel - n8n or Make - Webhooks / APIs	Reliability focus Contact matching, status tracking, duplicate control, handoff visibility, and error paths.
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Workflow architecture



How I would structure the build

1. Lead capture	Receive a WhatsApp inquiry or lead-form event and collect the fields needed for CRM matching, such as name, phone, source, and inquiry type.
2. Contact validation	Normalize and validate contact details before creating anything new. Existing contacts should be updated instead of intentionally creating duplicate records.
3. CRM update	Create or update the contact, attach source/context, and place the opportunity in the appropriate pipeline stage.
4. Qualification and routing	Use rule-based logic or AI-assisted intent detection to identify inquiry type, urgency, area, budget, or other available qualification fields, then route the lead accordingly.
5. Follow-up and team handoff	Send the approved WhatsApp follow-up, notify the assigned team member when human action is needed, and support appointment or reminder flows.
6. Status write-back	Update CRM notes, pipeline stage, last-contact time, assignment, and workflow status so the team can see what happened without checking multiple tools.

Lead states, safeguards and testing

The useful part of a CRM automation is not just sending messages. It is keeping contact ownership, pipeline state, consent-sensitive communication, and retries visible and controlled.

Example CRM tracking fields

Field	Example purpose
Lead Source	WhatsApp / Meta / Website / Referral / Manual
Contact Status	New / Contacted / Qualified / Follow-up / Closed
Pipeline Stage	New Lead / Contact Made / Appointment / Negotiation
Assigned User	Owner or agent responsible for next action
Last Contacted	Timestamp used for follow-up timing
Workflow Status	Ready / Processing / Completed / Error

Example fields only. Exact field names should match the client's existing CRM structure.

Reliability and safety controls

Duplicate prevention	Match contacts by normalized phone/email or another approved identifier before creating new CRM records.
Human handoff	When a lead replies with a question or reaches a qualified stage, route the conversation to the assigned person instead of over-automating.
Consent / DND awareness	Respect CRM communication status and do-not-disturb or opt-out fields before sending automated messages.
Failure visibility	If a CRM/API action fails, record the error state and stop dependent actions instead of pretending the lead moved successfully.
Retry behavior	Retry temporary API failures without intentionally creating duplicate contacts, opportunities, or repeated follow-up messages.

End-to-end test plan

Test	What I verify
New WhatsApp lead	Contact is created once, source is stored, stage is assigned, and follow-up triggers correctly.
Existing CRM contact	Existing record is updated rather than intentionally duplicated.
Qualified lead	Pipeline movement, owner notification, and next-action visibility work as expected.
Opt-out / DND case	Automated communication is prevented when the CRM indicates the lead should not be messaged.
Controlled API failure	Error state is visible and retry logic does not intentionally duplicate records or messages.

Scope note: This document is an independent workflow sample prepared to demonstrate the proposed implementation approach. It is not presented as a completed client deployment or as evidence of client results.